

PARTICIPANT GUIDE



Learning that leads to action.

Emotional Intelligence at Work

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Pework

Emotional intelligence is one’s ability to recognize and understand emotions in oneself and others, and to use this awareness to manage one’s behavior and relationships. Before our session, please complete the following steps to prepare yourself for our discussion:

1. **Review the five pillars of emotional intelligence:**
 - a. Self-awareness - the ability to understand your own emotions, strengths, and limitations.
 - i. Emotional self-awareness
 - b. Self-management - allows for managing the emotions and reproducing the desired response.
 - i. Emotional self-control
 - ii. Adaptability
 - iii. Achievement orientation
 - iv. Positive outlook
 - c. Motivation - enjoying what you are doing, working towards achieving goals, and exceeding the expectations set for you.
 - i. Goals and guides
 - d. Social awareness/Empathy - the ability to accurately sense how other people feel about a situation.
 - i. Organizational awareness
 - e. Social skills - allows for managing relationships that benefit everyone involved.
 - i. Influence
 - ii. Coach and mentor
 - iii. Conflict management
 - iv. Teamwork
 - v. Inspirational leadership
2. **Take this quiz on emotional intelligence.** Select “Take Free Test” then click “Start Assessment”.
3. **Review your results:** Your results will include scores in self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, and relationship management, along with recommended strategies for growth.
4. Reflection
 - a. Which area scored the highest for you?
 - b. Which area scored the lowest for you?

Course Overview

During this course, we will:

- ❑ Identify the importance of EQ in the workplace
- ❑ Use the SCARF model to identify and minimize threat response for increased EQ

Agenda

10 minutes	Introduction
22 minutes	Self-Awareness, Self-Regulation, & Empathy
25 minutes	SCARF Model
3 minutes	Closing

Poll

Have you had a great leader or mentor in your career?				
No, I have not. ☐	I am not sure. ☐	Maybe one? ☐	Definitely, at least one. ☐	Absolutely, several. ☐

Leadership Skills

What do you think are the top 2-3 most important leadership skills?

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Top 7 Leadership Skills

1. Emotional Intelligence
2. Communication
3. Ability to Coach Performance
4. Self-Awareness
5. Resilience
6. Financial Literacy
7. Technical Literacy



Pillars of Emotional Intelligence (EQ)

You completed the LEADx EQ-i assessment during the pre-work. Your scores range from 10 to 50:

- **10-34** - are for enrichment/improvement
- **35-44** - functioning effectively, but not a strength
- **45-50** - a strength to lean into

What about your results stood out to you, shocked you, or raised questions for you?



Self-Awareness

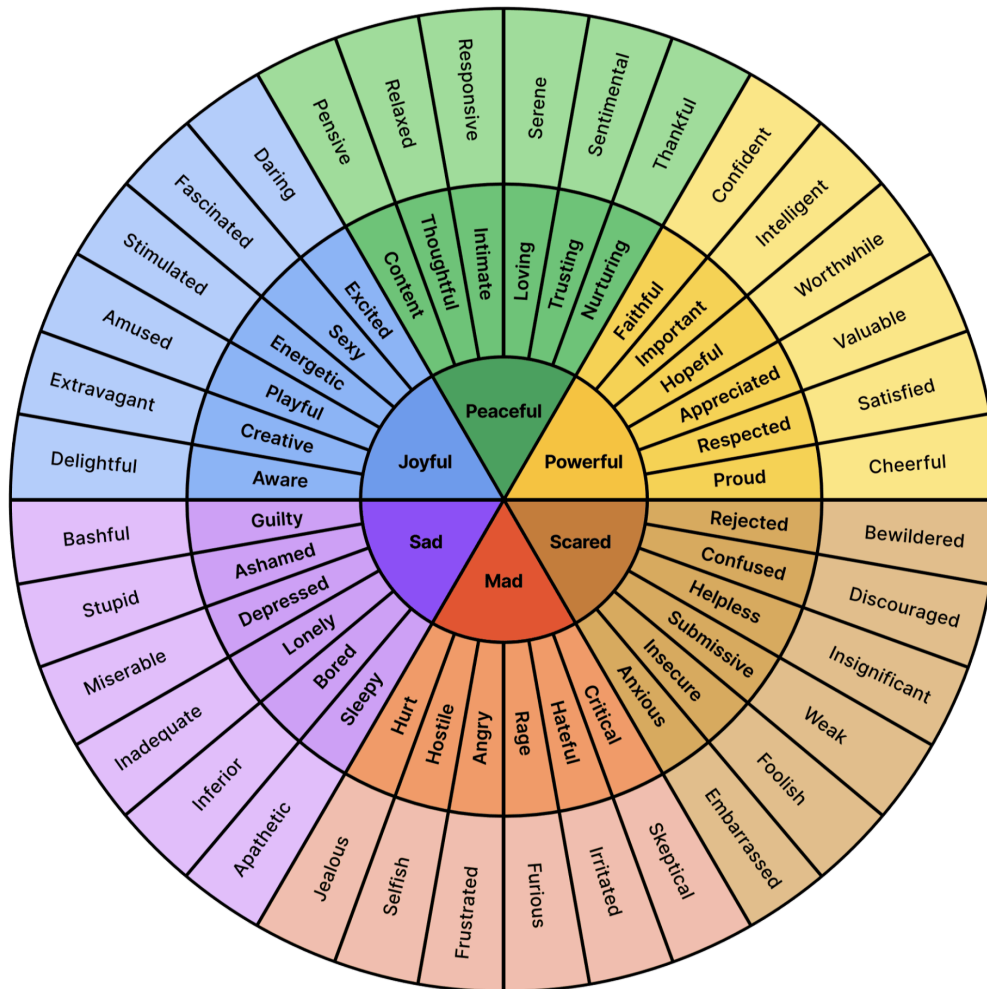
Take a look at the values listed below and circle/highlight  your top three. Don't overthink it. What jumps out to you immediately as the most important in your life?

What are your Core Values?

☐ Authenticity	☐ Fame	☐ Peace
☐ Achievement	☐ Friendships/Family	☐ Pleasure
☐ Adventure	☐ Fun	☐ Poise
☐ Authority	☐ Growth	☐ Popularity
☐ Balance	☐ Happiness	☐ Recognition
☐ Beauty	☐ Honesty	☐ Religion
☐ Boldness	☐ Humor	☐ Reputation
☐ Compassion	☐ Influence	☐ Respect
☐ Challenge	☐ Inner Harmony	☐ Responsibility
☐ Citizenship	☐ Kindness	☐ Self-Respect
☐ Community	☐ Knowledge	☐ Service
☐ Competency	☐ Leadership	☐ Spirituality
☐ Contribution	☐ Learning	☐ Stability
☐ Creativity	☐ Love	☐ Success
☐ Curiosity	☐ Loyalty	☐ Status
☐ Determination	☐ Meaningful Work	☐ Trustworthiness
☐ Fairness	☐ Openness	☐ Wealth
☐ Faith	☐ Optimism	☐ Wisdom

On the next page, you'll see the Emotion Wheel, which lists a large array of emotions that we feel in different circumstances. Based on the values you picked, answer the following questions:

Emotional Wheel



1. Pick three emotions to describe how you feel when your values are acknowledged and respected.
2. Pick three emotions to describe how you feel when your values are challenged.
3. How do you react when your values are challenged?

Triggered Communication Responses

<u>FIGHT</u> "I want to prove why I'm right" • Interrupting • Gaslighting • Hyper-aggression • Lack of listening skills • Controlling behaviors	<u>FLIGHT</u> "I don't want to deal with this" • Avoidance • Deflecting • Putting issues off • Not wanting to talk • Perfectionism
<u>FREEZE</u> "I don't know what to do" • Feeling stuck • Feeling numb • Dissociation • Not listening • Not replying	<u>FAWN</u> "I want everyone to be happy" • No boundaries • Lack of assertiveness • Prone to codependency • Negotiating against self • Saying "yes" to everything

Fight, flight, freeze, and fawn – we all have these instincts. These physiological reactions in our nervous system help us survive. Although they are automatic, they are also informed by our experiences and the stories we're told. When our values are challenged or when we feel triggered, we feel strong emotions, and we act based on those emotions. Our body is responding to a perceived threat in the moment to protect itself.

How Do You Respond When Triggered?

1. Reflect on the times when you felt triggered / your values were challenged and went to the fight/flight/freeze/fawn response.

What set you off?

How did you feel?

Which one of the four F's was your response?

What did you do and/or say?

What was the outcome?

2. Based on these experiences, identify your 2 – 3 triggers.

Self-awareness is a big step that leads to self-regulation. By paying attention to our triggers and how they make us feel, both physically and emotionally, we can learn to regulate our actions and responses. Being mindful of what triggers you can change the outcome of your story. But how do we get there?

Self-Regulation

How Do You Respond When Triggered?

1. Think about the times when you felt triggered / your values were challenged and how you responded (fight/flight/freeze/fawn response).

Is there another way to respond?

What can you do when you become aware of your emotions?

How can the outcome be different?

2. Identify TWO action items you can try next time you feel triggered / your values are challenged.

Breakout Check-in

1. What are your insights from your self-reflections?
 - Your values
 - Your triggers
 - Your emotions
 - Your responses/reactions
2. What TWO actions have you come up with?

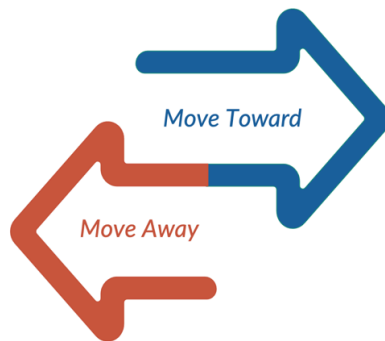
Empathy

Showing empathy for and understanding someone's emotions, triggers, and circumstances can also help us regulate how we react and behave in the moment.

What Gets in the Way?

Our *defensive styles* and our *stories*

Feels Threat



Feels Reward

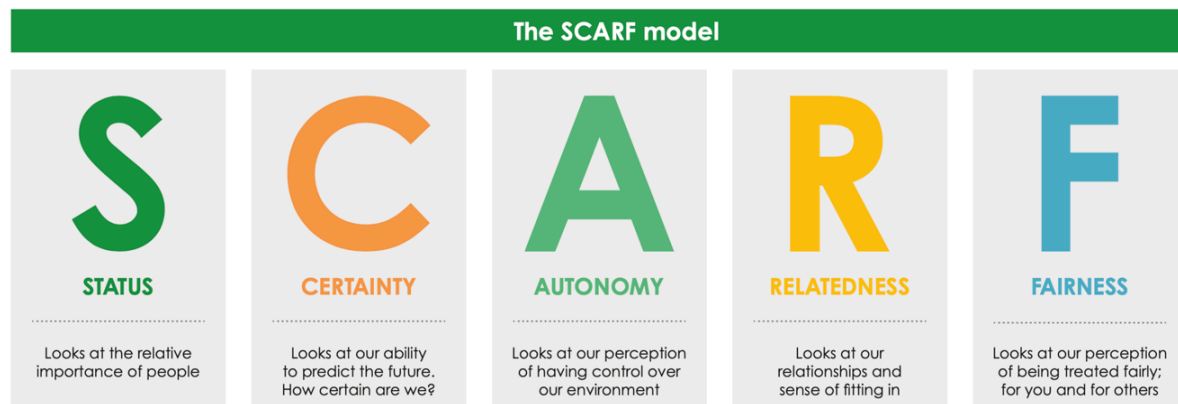


Away

&

Toward

SCARF & Defensive Styles



Take a look at these five social domains—Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, Fairness—[choose one or two](#) that are most important for you and [share in the chat](#).

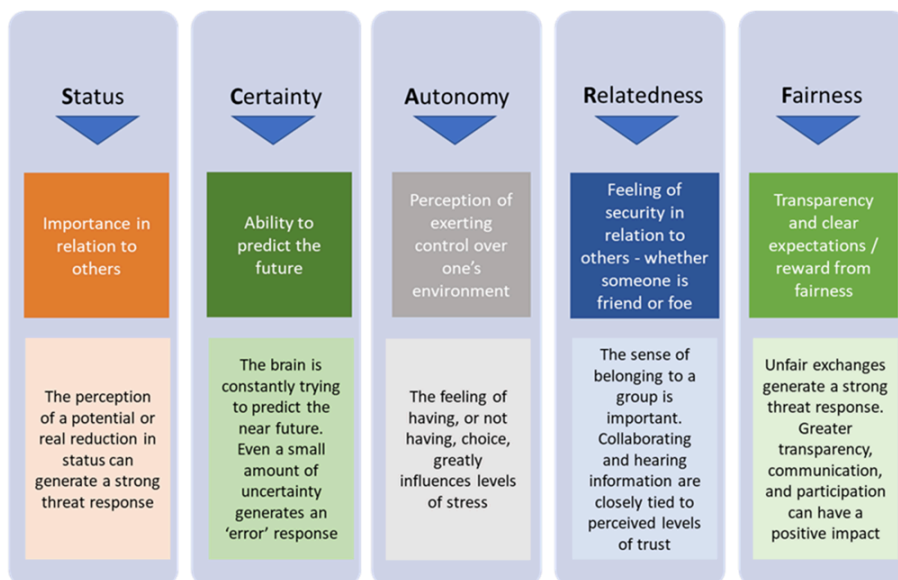
The SCARF® model is an acronym that categorizes five social domains in which we may experience signals (receive or send) of social threat or reward: status, certainty, autonomy, relatedness, and fairness. The SCARF® Model assesses the differences in people's social motivation. Some people are more sensitive to status threat and rewards, while others are to certainty and relatedness. Having SCARF needs satisfied drives [engagement](#) and retention.

- Status: How you see yourself and how others see you.
- Certainty: How confident you can be of the future.
- Autonomy: How much control you have over your life.
- Relatedness: How connected you feel to others.
- Fairness: How reasonable you feel decisions involving you have been.

When a person perceives a threat in one of these areas, the brain sends its resources to respond to the threat by triggering a survival response. Therefore, when someone perceives a social threat, they are unable to reason clearly or take in new learning. Because these threats occur based on perception, an event that might appear harmless or insignificant to one person may trigger a survival response in another. When leading or collaborating with others, it is important to plan for opportunities to strengthen a sense of belonging, autonomy, a sense of worth or status, as well as helping folks develop trust through consistency and fairness.

SCARF Discussion

1. Thinking back to your value trigger exercise – what SCARF domains were active for you?
2. How can you respond more effectively when triggered, using the SCARF model?



Leadership in Practice

Two departments are being asked to collaborate closely on a new initiative. One team worries they won't have much say in the process. The other team is concerned about taking on an extra workload.

Which SCARF domains might be threatened?

How could you, as a leader, respond in ways that reduce those threats and build collaboration?

Breakout Rooms

1. **Read the scenario** together in your group.
2. **Discuss:** Using the **SCARF model**, identify:
 - Which domains might feel threatened?
 - How could a leader respond in ways that reduce threat and build trust?
3. **Choose one person** to share your group's key ideas when we return.

Case Study #__

Case Study 1: Senior leadership has shared an update that shifts priorities across departments. Some of the work your team has been focused on will need to be adjusted, and the timeline for a key deliverable has changed. You may need to re-delegate parts of the project. How can you create a setting where your team is receptive to this change by minimizing potential threat responses?

Case Study 2: You notice that one of your consistently strong team members has recently become disengaged and missed a few key deadlines on an important cross-functional project. How can you approach them and give constructive feedback on their performance?

Case Study 3: You've recently been promoted to a manager role where you're now leading a team that includes some of your former peers, as well as colleagues from other departments you haven't worked with closely before. How can you create a culture of trust and collaboration while setting clear expectations for the team?

Case Study 4: One of your team members shares that they don't feel included in a project. They feel like they haven't been part of the decision-making process and are often assigned tasks that seem less meaningful. How can you resolve this conflict and create a stronger sense of inclusion?

Case Study 5: During a quarterly check-in, a team member is struggling to meet the goals you set together earlier in the year. When you start sharing feedback, they become defensive and claim to feel overwhelmed. How can you handle this conversation in a way that keeps them open and supported?

Case Study 6: You've been asked to lead a cross-functional project team that includes colleagues from Academics, IT, and People Ops. The project is high-stakes, with multiple stakeholders and tight deadlines. How can you manage this group to build trust, cooperation, and alignment while minimizing threat responses?

Actionable Takeaways

1. Use SCARF as a self-awareness checklist.
2. Use SCARF as a collaboration checklist.
3. Actively reduce threats and increase rewards.

BE A BETTER LEADER WITH SCARF

SCARF represents five areas influencing human behavior. The human brain wants to minimize danger or maximize reward which activate respective responses. It explains and helps to deal with human reactions, motivations, and interactions.

Status
Relative importance to others, personal worth

Certainty
Ability to predict the future

Autonomy
Sense of control over events

Relatedness
Feeling safe around others

Fairness
Perception of people interactions fairness

Reward state activators	Threat state activators
Positive and mutual feedback, public acknowledgment	Critique, unsolicited advice
Clear goals and expectations, feasible schedules	Non-transparent, dishonest and unpredictable behavior
Providing choices, empowerment, self-responsibility, self-organization	Micromanagement, command and control
Mentoring, enabling socializations	Internal competition, prohibition of socializing
Transparent decisions and communication, clear rules	Unequal conditions, lack of rules and communication

What's Next?

- ☐ Review the appendix to find out ways you can keep practicing SCARF in check-ins, reflections, and everyday interactions.
- ☐ Complete the [feedback form](#) so we can hear your thoughts on this session.

Appendix

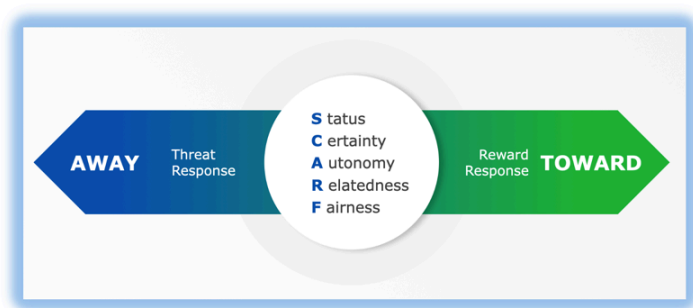
Use these prompts and resources to keep practicing what you learned today.

Next Step	What You Can Do
Apply SCARF at your quarterly check-in	Before your quarterly check-in, look back at your EQ scores & top 3 values. Ask yourself: Which SCARF domain might matter most? How can I reduce threat and increase reward during the conversation?
Reflection Journal (Optional)	After a meeting or check-in, jot down: • When did I notice someone's value or SCARF need being honored? • When did I see a potential trigger? • How did I respond, and what could I try next time?
Practice spotting SCARF in action	In your next team or cross-functional meeting, watch for reactions tied to Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, or Fairness . Pause to reflect on what that tells you about your team's needs right now.
Resources to Explore	• Steps on how to implement the SCARF model (pg.18) • Examples of how domains show up when triggered (pg.19) • Short video on empathy

Practical Steps for Leaders

To implement the SCARF model effectively, leaders can follow these practical steps:

1. Assess your current leadership approach, identifying areas lacking the SCARF domains.
2. Create an action plan that addresses each domain, focusing on improving specific aspects.
3. Set measurable goals and prioritize initiatives to ensure you make meaningful progress.
4. Encourage a culture of continuous improvement.



Examples of Domains when Triggered

